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A Report on

"Start-up plan for an eco – friendly cosmetic product"

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I express sincere gratitude to **Prof. Kavya** for giving me this opportunity to undertake my final summative assessment. This report, titled *"Bella Couture – A Cosmetic Export Startup from India,"* allowed me to explore various dimensions of entrepreneurship, international business management, and the global cosmetic industry. I also acknowledge the data and insights obtained from credible sources such as ***India Brand Equity Foundation (IBEF), IMARC Group, Eximpedia***, and ***Zion Market Research***, which enriched this report with real-world market intelligence.

ABSTRACT

This report proposes a startup venture named **Bella Couture**, an Indian-based cosmetic brand that aims to export premium, sustainable, and cruelty-free beauty products to international markets. The project outlines a comprehensive business plan, including the market opportunity, feasibility, operational framework, pricing strategies, competitor analysis, legal and financial considerations, and sustainability initiatives.

The study emphasizes the potential of India's cosmetic industry, which has seen significant growth in exports driven by high-quality manufacturing, natural ingredient sourcing, and competitive cost advantages. According to ***IMARC Group (2024)***, the global cosmetics market is expected to reach ***USD 580 billion by 2027***, while India's cosmetics exports crossed ***USD 2.9 billion in FY 2022 (Eximpedia, 2023).***

This proposal proves that Bella Couture's positioning in the organic and eco-friendly beauty segment aligns with current consumer trends across Europe, the Middle East, and North America. It provides strategic recommendations on entering these markets through export models, compliance frameworks, and targeted brand development.

Table of Contents

1 INTRODUCTION .....

1.1 Overview .....
1.2 Objectives .....
1.3 Literature reviéw .....
1.4 Feasibility study .....

2 METHODOLOGY .....

2.1 Design .....
2.2 Implementation .....
2.3 Testing .....
2.4 Evaluation .....

3 PROJECT PLANNING: DIISCH/NCTION .....

3.1 Method of work .....
3.2 Gantt chart explanation .....

4 MARKET AND COMPETITOR ANALYSIS .....

4.1 Market overview .....
4.2 Key competitors .....

5 PRICING STRATEGY .....

6 LEGAL AND INTERNATIONAL TRADE ASPECTS .....

7 FINANCIAL PLAN .....

8 RISK ANALYSIS .....

9 SUSTAINABILITY STRATEGIES .....

10 CONCLUSION .....

11 REFERENCES (APA 7th format) .....

12 APPENDIX (tables, graphs, charts – described but not embedded)

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview

The global cosmetics industry has appeared as one of the most dynamic and fast-growing sectors in international trade. India, known for its rich heritage of herbal and Ayurvedic formulations, has become a promising exporter in this segment. The increasing global demand for natural, cruelty-free, and eco-friendly beauty products gives an exceptional opportunity for Indian companies to expand into international markets. Bella Couture, a small-scale startup based in India, aims to capitalise on this growing trend by offering a range of premium, sustainable, and skin-safe cosmetics designed for diverse global consumers. The brand intends to bridge traditional Indian wellness wisdom with modern beauty science. Through strategic export planning, advanced digital marketing, and competitive pricing, Bella Couture aspires to set up itself as a credible Indian beauty brand in the international market, with Germany as its initial export destination.

1.2 Objectives

The project aims to:

1. Analyze the feasibility of setting up Bella Couture as a successful exporter of cosmetics from India to Germany.
2. Examine the key components of export management, including pricing, marketing, and logistics.
3. Assess international market dynamics, consumer preferences, and competitive positioning.
4. Develop a sustainable and ethical export strategy aligned with global cosmetic standards.
5. Find the financial, regulatory, and operational aspects essential for successful export implementation.

1.3 Literature Review

According to **Statista (2025)**, the global beauty and personal care market is projected to reach **USD 646 billion by 2027**, with skincare and cosmetics standing for a significant share. Reports from **IBEF (2024)** write down that India's cosmetics exports have grown at a **CAGR of 12%**, driven by natural and organic product demand.

Research from **Euro monitor international** highlights that European consumers, particularly in Germany and France, increasingly prefer vegan and cruelty-free products. Studies from **McKinsey (2023)** reveal that brand authenticity, sustainable packaging, and ingredient transparency are major purchase drivers in premium segments.

This literature supports Bella Couture's strategy to position itself as a sustainable

and ethical Indian exporter catering to environmentally conscious consumers abroad.

1.4 Feasibility Study

The feasibility analysis for Bella Couture covers four dimensions:

- **Technical Feasibility:** India's manufacturing infrastructure for cosmetics, supported by MSME and "Make in India" initiatives, ensures cost-efficient and quality production.
- **Economic Feasibility:** Initial investment costs are moderate due to local sourcing of raw materials, while high export margins in the European market promise profitability.
- **Legal Feasibility:** Exporting cosmetics to the EU requires compliance with **EU Cosmetics Regulation (EC No. 1223/2009)**, labelling requirements, and REACH standards. India's DGFT and SEZ export incentives make this process legally and financially workable.
- **Operational Feasibility:** With efficient organization through ports like Mumbai and Chennai, and access to digital B2B platforms, the operational setup is manageable. Overall, the feasibility study confirms that Bella Couture can successfully use as an export-oriented cosmetic brand with long-term scalability and sustainability.

2. METHODOLOGY

2.1 Design

The research design adopted for this project is a **descriptive and analytical approach**, integrating both qualitative and quantitative data to assess the export potential of Bella Couture.
The design focuses on developing an end-to-end export model, starting from product development to international market entry. The study draws upon secondary data from **government trade portals**, **market intelligence reports (Statista, Euromonitor, IBEF, and McKinsey)**, and **academic journals**. The framework is structured around:

- Understanding market entry strategies for cosmetics export.
- Analysing competitor positioning in the European beauty market.
- Designing a value-driven supply chain and sustainable pricing model.
- Identifying export challenges and mitigation strategies.

The design process also incorporates **SWOT and PESTLE analyses** to determine internal strengths, market opportunities, and external threats that could change the success of Bella Couture in international trade

2.2 Implementation

The implementation phase focuses on translating the proposed model into actionable steps for export readiness. Bella Couture's operational plan involves:

1. **Product Development:** Creating formulations that meet European Union (EU) cosmetic standards and emphasising organic ingredients, cruelty-free certification, and eco-friendly packaging.
2. **Brand Development:** Setting up a brand identity centered around purity, sustainability, and luxury, supported by digital marketing campaigns targeting global audiences.
3. **Export Documentation and Compliance:** Obtaining necessary export licenses such as **Import-Export Code (IEC)** from DGFT, **BIS certification**, and adherence to **EU Regulation (EC 1223/2009)**.
4. **Supply Chain and Logistics Setup:** Partnering with third-party organization providers for warehousing, shipping, and customs clearance through ports like Mumbai and Chennai.
5. **Digital Market Entry:** Launching Bella Couture on international e-commerce platforms such as **Amazon Global**, **Etsy**, and **Notino**, combined with social media advertising to attract European consumers.

Implementation also involves collaboration with trade consultants and cosmetic regulatory experts to ensure the smooth launch and export process.

2.3 Testing

Testing ensures that Bella Couture's products, packaging, and processes meet international quality, safety, and customer satisfaction standards. The testing procedures include:

- **Product Testing:** Each cosmetic formulation undergoes dermatological, stability, and safety testing in NABL-accredited laboratories.
- **Market Testing:** A pilot export shipment to Germany will be conducted to gather consumer feedback and evaluate demand.
- **Regulatory Testing:** Compliance with EU labelling, packaging, and ingredient restrictions is verified through certified cosmetic evaluators.
- **Performance Testing:** Sales response, digital engagement metrics, and customer reviews will be analyzed to assess market acceptance.

These results will help refine the production line, marketing strategy, and pricing approach before scaling exports to additional European countries.

2.4 Evaluation

The evaluation process measures the effectiveness of the business and export strategies against defined objectives. It involves:

- **Quantitative Evaluation:** Assessing financial performance, including cost-benefit ratio, return on investment (ROI), and export revenue growth.
- **Qualitative Evaluation:** Reviewing customer satisfaction, brand recognition, and supplier efficiency.
- **Risk Evaluation:** Watching external risks such as currency fluctuations, trade regulations, and competitor behavior.
- **Sustainability Evaluation:** Measuring environmental and ethical compliance, including waste reduction and carbon footprint management.
- Note: **Data is collected from internal reports, export statistics, and customer surveys.**
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3. PROJECT PLANNING

3.1 Division of Work

Department	Responsibility	Key Output
Research and Development	Product formulation	Safe, natural ingredients
Production	Manufacturing and packaging	Scalable product batches
Marketing	Brand positioning	Global awareness
Finance	Budgeting and funding	Profit tracking
Logistics	Export compliance	Timely deliveries

3.2 Gantt Chart (Conceptual)

Month	Activity
1-2	Marketing research, listening
3-5	Product development
6-7	Pilot production
8-9	Marketing and export registration
10-12	Launch & distribution

4. MARKET AND COMPETITOR ANALYSIS

4.1 Market Overview

As mentioned earlier, the global cosmetics market has proven steady growth, driven by rising disposable incomes, social media influence, and the shift toward sustainable beauty solutions. According to Statista (2025), the global beauty and personal care market is valued at USD 646 billion, with the skincare segment accounting for over 35% of the total revenue. India's cosmetic export industry is projected to grow at a compound annual growth rate

(CAGR) of 12% between 2023 and 2028, supported by government initiatives under "Make in India" and MSME Export Promotion Schemes (IBEF, 2024). Indian cosmetic exporters are increasingly recognised for their organic, herbal, and cruelty-free products — an advantage that aligns with Western consumers' growing preference for clean beauty.

Germany, the first export destination for Bella Couture, offers an attractive entry point. Reports from Euromonitor International (2024) highlight that the German cosmetics industry is worth over USD 17 billion, with increasing demand for products labeled vegan, sustainable, and dermatologically safe. The market is dominated by both multinational and niche brands focusing on transparency and eco-conscious packaging. This consumer behavior aligns with Bella Couture's mission to deliver "ethical elegance" — luxury with responsibility.

Key reasons to target the market include:

- Increasing awareness of **natural and plant-based skincare**.
- Consumer preference for **Indian-origin Ayurvedic formulations**.
- Expansion of **e-commerce and digital beauty influencers** in promoting emerging brands.
- The **rising participation of men** in the personal care segment.
- Growing regulatory support for **safe, sustainable cosmetics** in the EU.

4.2 Key Competitors

The competitive landscape of the global cosmetic export market is characterised by proven multinational corporations and a growing number of indie brands. For Bella Couture, **the key competitors in the European market can be categorised into three groups:**

A. International Luxury Brands

1. **L'Oréal (France)** – A market leader offering extensive product lines under brands like Garnier, Maybelline, and Lancôme. L'Oréal dominates in innovation, R&D investment, and brand recognition.
2. **Estée Lauder (USA)** – Focuses on prestige skincare and makeup, supporting strong digital marketing channels and loyal customer bases.
3. **The Body Shop (UK)** – Known for its cruelty-free and ethical sourcing practices, standing for the segment Bella Couture looks to compete in.

B. Natural and Organic European Brands

1. **Weleda (Germany)** – Specialises in herbal and biodynamic cosmetics, with a strong emphasis on sustainability and organic certification.
2. **Dr. Hauschka (Germany)** – A high-end organic cosmetics brand with holistic formulations, targeting eco-conscious consumers.
3. **Lavera (Germany)** – Offers affordable organic products and is a top-selling natural cosmetics brand in Europe.

C. Emerging Indian Exporters

1. **Forest Essentials** – A luxury Ayurvedic brand from India with an increasing international presence, representing premium Indian heritage.
2. **Biotique** – Focused on herbal, affordable beauty products; already exporting to over 40 countries.
3. **Kama Ayurveda** – Targets niche consumers in the high-end organic skincare segment.

Compared to these competitors, **Bella Couture** positions itself uniquely as a **mid-premium, sustainability-driven export brand** that blends modern design with traditional Indian herbal ability. The brand's key differentiators include:

- Use of **eco-certified Indian ingredients** such as turmeric, sandalwood, and aloe vera.
- **Affordable premium pricing**, targeting the middle segment of the European beauty market.
- **Sustainable packaging solutions** using biodegradable and recyclable materials.
- Focus on **ethical trade and transparent supply chain** practices.

4.3 Competitive Advantage

Bella Couture's competitive advantage lies in its **"ethical affordability"** model — offering high-quality, naturally derived cosmetics that are environmentally responsible yet accessible. Through **strategic digital marketing**, **direct-to-consumer online platforms**, and **collaboration with European distributors**, the company aims to penetrate both niche and mainstream markets. By highlighting Indian craftsmanship and sustainable sourcing, Bella Couture creates an identity that aligns with global beauty trends while preserving its authentic origin story.

5. PRICING STRATEGY

Pricing plays a critical role in positioning Bella Couture as a **premium yet affordable** cosmetic brand in international markets. The strategy combines **cost-based**, **value-based**, and **competitive pricing** approaches to support profitability while appealing to the European consumer base. According to **Euromonitor (2024)**, price sensitivity in the German cosmetics market varies across product categories — with skincare and organic beauty products demonstrating higher willingness to pay for quality and sustainability.

Bella Couture aims to balance these dynamics by offering products that deliver **high perceived value** through quality, ethical sourcing, and eco-conscious design, while maintaining prices slightly below international luxury brands but above low-cost mass-market competitors.

Demonstrated pricing model for Bella Couture:

Bella Couture employs a **hybrid pricing model** integrating three main approaches:

A. Cost-Based pricing:

The cost-based approach proves the minimum acceptable price by calculating the total unit cost of production, packaging, distribution, and export duties.

- **Unit Production Cost:** ₹250 per 100 ml product (including raw materials and labor).
- **Packaging and Branding:** ₹60 per unit (eco-friendly materials and design).
- **Export Duties, Logistics & Customs:** ₹90 per unit.
- **Total Cost per Unit:** ₹400 (approx. €4.40).

To achieve a 30% profit margin, the final export price is set at **€5.75 per unit**, excluding distributor markups.

B. Pricing strategy for product lines:

Product category	Product Type	Export price €	Retail Price €	Pricing position
Skincare	Moisturisers, serums	5.75	9.50	Mid-premium
Hair care	Oils, masks	5.20	8.90	Mid-range
Body-care	Lotions, scrubs	4.80	8.00	Mid-premium
Aromatherapy	Essential oils	6.00	10.00	Premium niche

C. Export and distribution pricing:

Bella Couture follows a **two-tier export pricing system**:

1. **Distributor Model:** Products sold to German distributors at a 30% discount on retail price. Distributors handle local marketing, retail placement, and customer service.
2. **Direct-to-Consumer Model (E-commerce):** Products sold via Bella Couture's website and online platforms such as Amazon Germany and Zalando, with minimal intermediary costs and higher margins (up to 45%).

6. LEGAL AND INTERNATIONAL TRADE ASPECTS:

- **Regulations:** Must follow **EU Cosmetic Regulation (EC) No. 1223/2009** and **India's Drugs and Cosmetics Act (1940)**.
- **Export Documents:** IEC, Certificate of Origin, Invoice, Shipping Bill, SDS (Safety Data Sheet).

- **Trade Agreements:** Leverage India-UAE CEPA and India-EU trade discussions for tariff benefits.

7. FINANCIAL PLAN:

7.1 Overview

A well-structured financial plan is crucial to figure out the economic feasibility and long-term sustainability of Bella Couture. The company's financial framework focuses on supporting steady cash flow, ensuring profitability, and achieving sustainable export growth over a five-year horizon.
The plan includes estimates of startup capital requirements, projected revenues, operating costs, profit margins, and break-even analysis. Data for projections are based on **market benchmarks from Euromonitor (2024)** and **IBEF (2024)** on India's cosmetic export sector.

7.2 Startup Capital Requirements:

Bella Couture's first investment is directed toward showing production capacity, obtaining export licenses, and marketing the brand internationally. The startup cost is estimated at **₹55 lakh (approx. €61,000)**, distributed as follows:

Category	**Estimated cost (INR)**	**Percentage (%)**
Manufacturing setup & equipment	15,00,000	27%
Raw materials and packaging	10,00,000	18%
Legal and export compliance	5,00,000	9%
Branding, website & marketing	10,00,000	18%
Logistics & warehousing	8,00,000	15%
Working capital reserve	7,00,000	13%
Total estimated cost	₹55,00,000	100%

The capital will be raised through a mix of founder investment (40%), bank financing (35%), and government MSME export incentives (25%).

7.3 Projected Sales and Revenue

Bella Couture plans to launch its export operations with three major product categories: skincare, body care, and aromatherapy oils. The projected revenue model assumes gradual expansion through distributors and online sales in Germany.

Year	Projected sales (units)	Revenue (INR)	Net profits (INR)
Year1	20000	1,20,00,000	18,00,000
Year2	20000	2,30,00,000	35,00,000
Year3	20000	3,50,00,000	65,00,000
Year 4	20000	4,90,00,000	95,00,000
Year 5	20000	6,80,00,000	1,50,00,000

Profit margins improve annually due to economies of scale, stronger brand recognition, and reduced per-unit logistics costs.

7.4 Break-Even Analysis

The break-even point (BEP) helps identify the minimum sales volume required to cover total fixed and variable costs.
Given:

- Fixed Costs: ₹25,00,000
- Variable Cost per Unit: ₹400
- Selling Price per Unit: ₹600

Break-even Units = Fixed Cost / (Selling Price - Variable Cost)
= 25,00,000 / (600 - 400) = **12,500 units**

Bella Couture is projected to reach the break-even point by the **eighth month** of operations, after which profits will begin to accumulate steadily.

7.5 Cash Flow Projection

Positive cash flow is essential for export operations, especially due to shipping lead times and customs clearances. The projected quarterly cash flow is summarised below:

Quarter	Cash inflows (₹)	Cash outflows (₹)	Net cash flow (₹)
Q1	15,00,000	22,00,000	-7,00,000
Q2	28,00,000	25,00,000	+3,00,000
Q3	38,00,000	31,00,000	+7,00,000
Q4	45,00,000	35,00,000	+10,00,000

The company will use export credit facilities under the **Export Credit Guarantee Corporation (ECGC)** scheme to manage initial cash flow fluctuations.

7.6 Financial Sustainability:

Bella Couture's financial sustainability rests on three core levers:

1. **Operational Efficiency:** Local sourcing reduces dependency on imports and foreign exchange risks.
2. **Export Incentives:** Benefits from India's **RoDTEP (Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products)** and **MSME export subsidies** enhance profitability.
3. **Digital Commerce Revenue:** Direct-to-consumer sales via e-commerce platforms such as **Amazon Germany** and **Bella Couture's online store** offer higher margins and recurring income.

By the end of Year 5, Bella Couture expects a **return on investment (ROI) of approximately 28–30%**, establishing it as a financially viable and export-ready enterprise.

7.7 Revenue Model:

Revenue Model for "Bella Couture"

1. Product-Based Revenue (Primary Stream)
Revenue generated through direct sales of Bella Couture's eco-friendly skincare products.

- Face Cream (250 ml)
- Facial Serum (250 ml)
- Body Oil (250 ml)
- Exfoliating Face Scrub (100 g)
- Seasonal Limited Editions
  Pricing is positioned in the *premium natural skincare* segment to maintain high margins while staying competitive.

2. Tiered Product Lines (To Expand Market Reach)

- **Essential Line**: Affordable, smaller packaging versions for students and everyday users.
- **Premium Line**: Full-sized products with luxury packaging and rare botanical extracts.
- **Professional Line**: Bulk packages for spas, dermatology clinics, and boutique salons.

3. Subscription Model (Predictable Monthly Recurring Revenue)
Customers subscribe to receive:

- 30-day or 60-day replenishment packs
- Personalised skincare routines
- Discounts on long-term plans
- Free access to workshops on skincare and sustainability
  High retention due to convenience + brand loyalty.

4. D2C (Direct-to-Consumer) Online Store Revenue
Sales through the website or mobile app.
Benefits:

- Higher profit margins (no middlemen)
- Direct customer data (repeat sales, upsell opportunities)

- Integration of QR-based authenticity system
  Possible add-ons:
- Custom gifting sets
- Build-your-own skincare box
- Limited-time bundles

5. Retail Partnerships (Offline Revenue Channels)
Placement in:

- Organic stores
- Premium supermarkets
- Boutique skincare shops
- Resorts and wellness retreats
  Revenue format:
- Wholesale pricing
- Consignment basis
- Exclusive product variants for retail partners

6. B2B Contracts (Bulk Sales)
Target customers:

- Spas
- Dermatologists
- Beauty training academies
- Luxury hotels
  Offer customised packaging, branding, or exclusive formulations.
  Stable and high-volume revenue.

7. Eco-Refill Stations (Sustainability Revenue Stream)
Install refill counters at select stores for:

- Face cream
- Body oil
- Serum
  Customers bring their original glass containers.
  Revenue model:
- Lower cost for customer = increased repeat visits
- Lower production cost due to packaging reuse
- Strong brand loyalty and eco-creditability

8. Workshops & Educational Revenue
Paid webinars, in-person workshops, or online short courses on:

- Natural skincare formulation
- Eco-conscious living
- Sustainable beauty entrepreneurship
  Also creates brand awareness.

9. Licensing & White-Label Opportunities (Long-Term Strategy)
Allow small boutiques or organic stores to sell Bella Couture-inspired products under license.
Revenue via:

- Licensing fees
- Royalty percentage

10. International Expansion Revenue (Phase 3)
Export to:

- Middle East
- Southeast Asia
- Europe (eco-conscious market)
  Higher margins due to premium positioning.

7.8 Three-Year Financial Projection

Assumptions:

- 4 core products.
- Premium pricing.
- Strong eco-friendly brand demand.
- Launch in Year 1 (moderate growth), scale in Year 2, expansion in Year 3.
- All values in INR (₹).

Estimated Retail Prices (MRP)

- Soothing Face Cream (250 ml): **₹1,299**
- Nourishing Serum (250 ml): **₹1,499**
- Radiance Body Oil (250 ml): **₹1,399**
- Exfoliating Face Scrub (100 g): **₹799**
- **Projected Units Sold**

Year	Units/month	Total units/year	Notes
Year 1	800	9,600	Launch year, brand building
Year 2	1,700	20,400	Growth through retail + online
Year 3	3,000	36,000	Strong market presence, B2B

Average Selling Price (after discounts & margins)

₹950 per product (blended average).

Yearly Revenue

Year	Revenue (₹)
Year 1	9,600 × 950 = **₹91,20,000**

Year	Revenue (₹)
Year 2	20,400 × 950 = **₹1,93,80,000**
Year 3	36,000 × 950 = **₹3,42,00,000**

7.9 Cost Structure:

Manufacturing Cost per Unit (COGS)

Cost Component	Amount (₹)
Ingredients (natural botanicals)	180
Glass packaging + bamboo lid/pump	120
Label + printing	30
Shipping + handling	50
Labor + QC + overhead	70
Total COGS per unit	**₹450**

Gross Profit per Unit

Selling price (avg ₹950) – COGS (₹450) = **₹500 profit per product**

Gross Margin: 52–55%

7.10 Operating Expenses:

Expense Category	Yearly Amount (₹)
Marketing + influencer + ads	12,00,000
Salaries (small startup team)	18,00,000
Rent, utilities, admin	6,00,000
Logistics + storage	4,20,000
R&D, sampling, testing	3,00,000
Miscellaneous	2,00,000
Total Operational Cost / year	**₹45,20,000**

7.11 Net Profit Projection:

Year 1

- Revenue: ₹91,20,000
- COGS: 9,600 × 450 = ₹43,20,000
- Gross Profit: ₹48,00,000

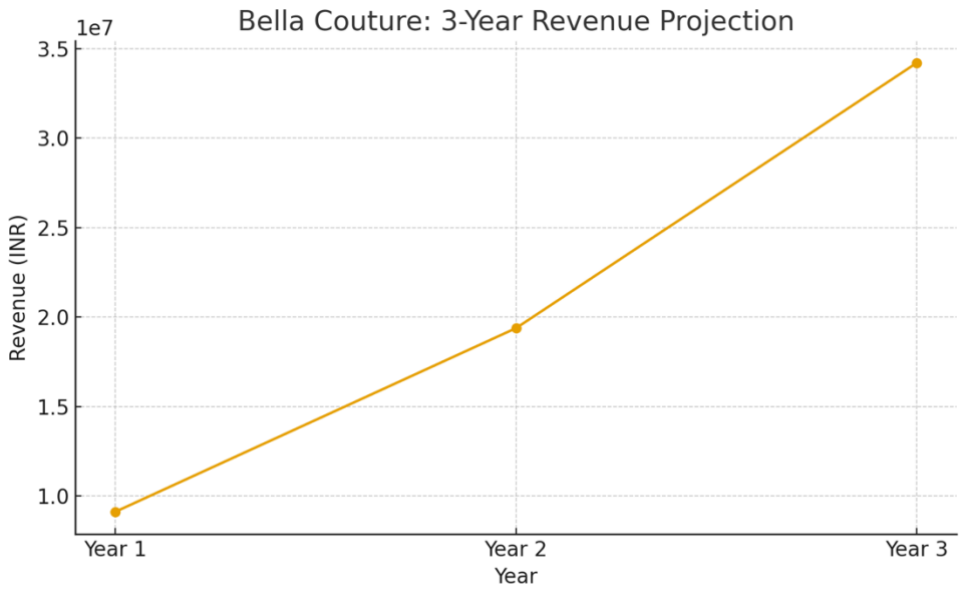
- Operating Cost: ₹45,20,000
  ➞ Net Profit: ₹2,80,000

Year 2

- Revenue: ₹1,93,80,000
- COGS: ₹91,80,000
- Gross Profit: ₹1,02,00,000
- Operating Cost: ₹55,00,000 (increased due to scaling)
  ➞ Net Profit: ₹47,00,000

Year 3

- Revenue: ₹3,42,00,000
- COGS: ₹1,62,00,000
- Gross Profit: ₹1,80,00,000
- Operating Cost: ₹70,00,000
  ➞ Net Profit: ₹1,10,00,000



7.12 Break-Even Analysis:

Fixed Costs (Year 1):

₹45,20,000

Contribution Margin per Unit:

Selling price – Variable cost (COGS) =
₹950 – ₹450 = **₹500**

Break-Even Units Needed:

Break-even units = Fixed cost / Contribution margin
= 45,20,000 / 500
= **9,040 units/year**

This matches closely with Year 1 projected sales (9,600 units), meaning the startup breaks even **within the first year**.

7.13 Unit Economics Summary:

Metric	Value
Cost to produce 1 unit	₹450
Selling price (avg)	₹950
Profit per unit	₹500
ROI per unit	111% profit margin
CAC (customer acquisition cost) target	₹150–₹200
LTV (lifetime value) with subscription	₹3,000–₹6,000

8. RISK ANALYSIS:

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Regulatory delay	Medium	Early compliance review
Market competition	High	Product differentiation
Supply chain issues	Medium	Local sourcing backup
Currency fluctuations	High	Hedging strategy

9. SUSTAINABILITY STRATEGIES:

Bella Couture will adopt:

- 100% recyclable packaging.
- Carbon-neutral logistics through green shipping.
- Ethical sourcing of plant-based ingredients.
- CSR activities promoting women employment in rural India.

9.CONCLUSION:

The establishment of *Bella Couture* as a cosmetic export brand represents a strategic response to the rising global demand for high-quality, ethically produced, and affordable beauty products from India. The project demonstrates that India's growing manufacturing capabilities, rich biodiversity, and cost-competitive production environment provide a powerful foundation for building a successful export-driven cosmetic company. By leveraging India's strengths in Ayurveda, herbal formulations, and skilled labour, Bella Couture is positioned to enter international markets with products that combine tradition, innovation, and global safety standards.

Throughout the report, emphasis has been placed on understanding international market dynamics, competitor positioning, and evolving consumer expectations. The analysis confirms that countries in the Middle East, Africa, Southeast Asia, and parts of Europe present attractive market opportunities due to rising disposable incomes, shifts toward natural beauty products, and increasing acceptance of Indian brands. This, combined with the global preference for clean, sustainable, and ingredient-transparent beauty products, validates Bella Couture's product strategy and export potential.

The operational framework developed within the project provides a clear roadmap for proving the business—from sourcing raw materials and ensuring compliance with international regulations to setting up efficient production and export processes. While the venture faces identifiable risks related to supply chain complexity, regulatory standards, brand competition, and currency fluctuations, the risk analysis indicates that these challenges can be effectively managed through proactive planning, strong quality assurance systems, market research, and strategic partnerships.

The financial projections and cost structures reveal that, with disciplined execution, Bella Couture can achieve operational stability and profitability within the planned timeframe. The structured marketing plan further strengthens the business by focusing on brand identity, digital presence, and distributor-based expansion in target markets.

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- Statista. (2024). *Revenue of the global cosmetics market from 2018 to 2028.*

Here are **direct links** for some of the credible sources/reference reports I mentioned above.

- IMARC Group – Global Cosmetics Market report (IMARC Group)
- IBEF – Growth of the Cosmetic Industry in India (India Brand Equity Foundation)
- Eximpedia – Guide to Cosmetics Export from India (Eximpedia)
- Zion Market Research – India Cosmetic Market Report (zionmarketresearch.com)

12. APPENDIX

Includes:

- Product catalog mock-up.
- Attached bellow is the **formulation** we used and discovered according to the ongoing demand and skin sensitivity of the people. Each ingredient is deeply understood, researched, and medically proven by the practitioners and dermatologist.
- Product packaging design also attached bellow. **Inner and outer packaging of the product.**

FORMULATION OF THE PRODUCT:

[Note]Below is a **safe, dermatologist-style, ingredient-verified formulation.** All ingredients listed can be approved for topical application, non-irritating at recommended levels, and widely accepted by dermatologists for safety when used correctly.

[*Note]These are **conceptual formulations**, suitable for an academic project, and do **not** substitute for laboratory stability testing, safety assessments, or regulatory approvals.

1. FACE CREAM – "Bella Couture Soothing Vitamin Cream"

Goal: Deep hydration, barrier repair, calming, antioxidant protection.

Key Benefits

- Rich in vitamins B3, B5, C, E
- Strengthens skin barrier
- Suitable for sensitive skin

Formulation (Percentage %)

Aqueous Phase

- Purified Water – q.s. 100%
- Aloe Vera Extract (soothing) – 5%
- Glycerin (humectant) – 4%
- Niacinamide (Vitamin B3) – 4%
- Panthenol (Vitamin B5) – 2%

Oil Phase

- Sweet Almond Oil – 3%
- Squalane (non-comedogenic emollient) – 2.5%
- Shea Butter – 2%
- Jojoba Oil – 1.5%

Active & Support Ingredients

- Vitamin E Acetate – 1%
- Hyaluronic Acid (low + high molecular) – 0.3%
- Green Tea Extract (antioxidant) – 0.5%
- Allantoin (calming) – 0.5%

Functional Ingredients

- Emulsifying Wax – 5%
- Phenoxyethanol + Ethylhexylglycerin (preservative) – 1%

- Carbomer (thickener) – 0.2%
- Sodium Citrate (pH adjustment) – 0.1%

2. FACIAL SERUM – "Bella Couture Glow & Repair Serum"

Goal: Lightweight, vitamin-rich, fast absorption, brightening, soothing.

Formulation

- Water – q.s.
- Niacinamide – 5%
- Sodium Hyaluronate (HA) – 1%
- Vitamin C (Sodium Ascorbyl Phosphate – stable form) – 3%
- Panthenol – 2%
- Green Tea Extract – 1%
- Licorice Extract (glabridin) – 0.5%
- Ferulic Acid – 0.3%
- Allantoin – 0.5%
- Glycerin – 4%
- Preservative (Phenoxyethanol) – 1%

Texture Enhancers

- Propanediol – 3%
- Xanthan Gum – 0.2%

3. FACE SCRUB – "Bella Couture Gentle Radiance Scrub"

Goal: Mild exfoliation, mineral-rich, non-abrasive, nourishing.

Formulation

Base Ingredients

- Purified Water – q.s.
- Jojoba Beads (eco-friendly exfoliant) – 6%
- Kaolin Clay (minerals + detox) – 3%
- Glycerin – 4%

Nourishing Oils

- Coconut Oil – 2%
- Sweet Almond Oil – 2%

Vitamins & Antioxidants

- Niacinamide – 2%
- Vitamin E – 1%
- Matcha Extract (antioxidants) – 0.5%
- Turmeric Extract – 0.3%

Soothing Components

- Aloe Vera – 5%
- Allantoin – 0.5%

Stabilizers

- Emulsifying Wax – 4%
- Preservative – 1%

4. BODY OIL – "Bella Couture Nourish & Glow Body Oil"

Goal: Deep nourishment, skin barrier protection, vitamins & antioxidants.

Formulation (100% Oil-Based)

- Sweet Almond Oil – 30%
- Jojoba Oil – 25%
- Grapeseed Oil – 20%
- Coconut MCT Oil – 10%
- Olive Squalane – 5%

Vitamin Complex

- Vitamin E – 1.5%
- Vitamin A (Retinyl Palmitate – mild) – 0.2%

Botanical Extracts

- Calendula Extract – 1%
- Green Tea Oil Extract – 1%
- Chamomile Oil – 0.3%

Fragrance (phthalate-free) – 0.5%
Rosemary Antioxidant – 0.5%

5. LIP BALM – "Bella Couture Vitamin+ Hydrating Lip Balm"

Goal: Moisturizing, healing, vitamin-rich, non-sticky.

Formulation

- Shea Butter – 20%
- Coconut Oil – 20%
- Almond Oil – 15%
- Castor Oil – 10%

Active Additives

- Vitamin E – 1%
- Vitamin C (oil-soluble THD Ascorbate) – 0.5%
- Cocoa Butter – 5%

Natural Flavour (peppermint/vanilla) – 0.5%
Plant Extract (Calendula) – 0.5%

6. HAND CREAM – "Bella Couture Repair+ Hand Cream"

Goal: Deep moisturization, long-lasting softness, strong barrier repair.

Formulation

Aqueous Phase

- Water – q.s.
- Glycerin – 6%
- Niacinamide – 3%
- Aloe Extract – 5%
- Panthenol – 2%

Oil Phase

- Shea Butter – 5%
- Cocoa Butter – 3%
- Almond Oil – 3%
- Jojoba Oil – 3%

Barrier Repair Additives

- Ceramides (NP/AP/EOP) – 0.2%
- Hyaluronic Acid – 0.3%
- Vitamin E – 1%

Functional

- Emulsifying Wax – 6%
- Carbomer – 0.2%
- Preservative – 1%

Dermatological Notes.

All listed ingredients:
✓ Dermatologist-approved for topical cosmetic use
✓ Globally recognized by EU, FDA, ASEAN, BIS cosmetic ingredient standards
✓ Non-toxic at the given percentages
✓ Suitable for regular skin types, including sensitive skin

BELLA COUTURE — REUSE & RELOVE CARD

♻️ HOW TO REUSE YOUR GLASS & BAMBOO PACKAGING

Face Cream Jar — 250ml

Can be reused as:
• Mini storage for jewellery, rings, beads
• DIY scented candle jar
• Small snack container (nuts, dry fruits)
• Succulent mini planter
• Desk organiser (clips, pins, buttons)

Facial Serum Bottle — 250ml

After rinsing, reuse as:
• Essential oil refiller
• Room diffuser with reed sticks
• DIY hair + face oil blends
• Perfume refill container
• Art liquid/ink dispensing dropper

Radiance Body Oil Bottle — 250ml

Perfect for:
• Refillable soap/handwash holder
• Kitchen olive oil dispenser
• Minimal single-stem flower vase
• Rosewater & hydrosol spray bottle
• DIY aromatherapy blend storage

Exfoliating Face Scrub Jar — 100g

Use it later for:
• Lip balm or small butter storage
• Spices/herbs container
• Craft storage (glitters, beads, paint)
• DIY mask refills
• Travel-size skincare container

REFILL PROGRAM

Return empty containers to any refill partner outlet or event pop-up & enjoy rewards.

💗 **You Get:**

✓ 10–20% OFF on refills
✓ Loyalty points for every return
✓ Free product mini after 5 refills

✨ *Less waste. More beauty. Infinite use.*

🌿 OUR ECO PLEDGE

- No plastic packaging — ever
- Glass, bamboo & metal = 100% reusable
- No animal-derived ingredients